# StoryCast: Research & Planning

Everyday People: an accessible audio and video storytelling microsite · Formative assessment

## 1. Problem statement

Short everyday stories, whether told in words, in sound or in pictures, are often hard to follow for people who are Deaf or hard of hearing, blind or partially sighted, neurodivergent, or who simply can't play sound. Captions are often missing, transcripts are hard to find, and silent or visual-only video is rarely described.

**Goal:** a small, calm, three-page-type microsite where every story can be watched, heard *or* read, built with semantic HTML, Sass and vanilla JavaScript, meeting WCAG 2.1 AA.

## 2. Audience & proto-personas

These personas are assumptions I drew from the brief and WCAG user needs.

### Amina, 34: Deaf, BSL user

Watches on her phone on the bus. Needs accurate captions that include sound cues, and a transcript she can skim. Frustrated when captions are off by default.

### David, 58: blind, screen reader user (NVDA)

Navigates by headings and landmarks. Needs real buttons with clear names, audio description for visual-only content, and no keyboard traps in media players.

### Leo, 19: student with ADHD

Prefers short content and reading along. Distracted by motion and autoplay. Values a predictable layout and a visible "where am I" in the transcript.

## 3. Content strategy

| Story | Type | Source | Why it's included |
|---|---|---|---|
| The Long Walk | Video (native <video>), 0:48, silent | Cloudinary sample library | Featured story. A silent clip, so the audio description and transcript carry the whole story. |

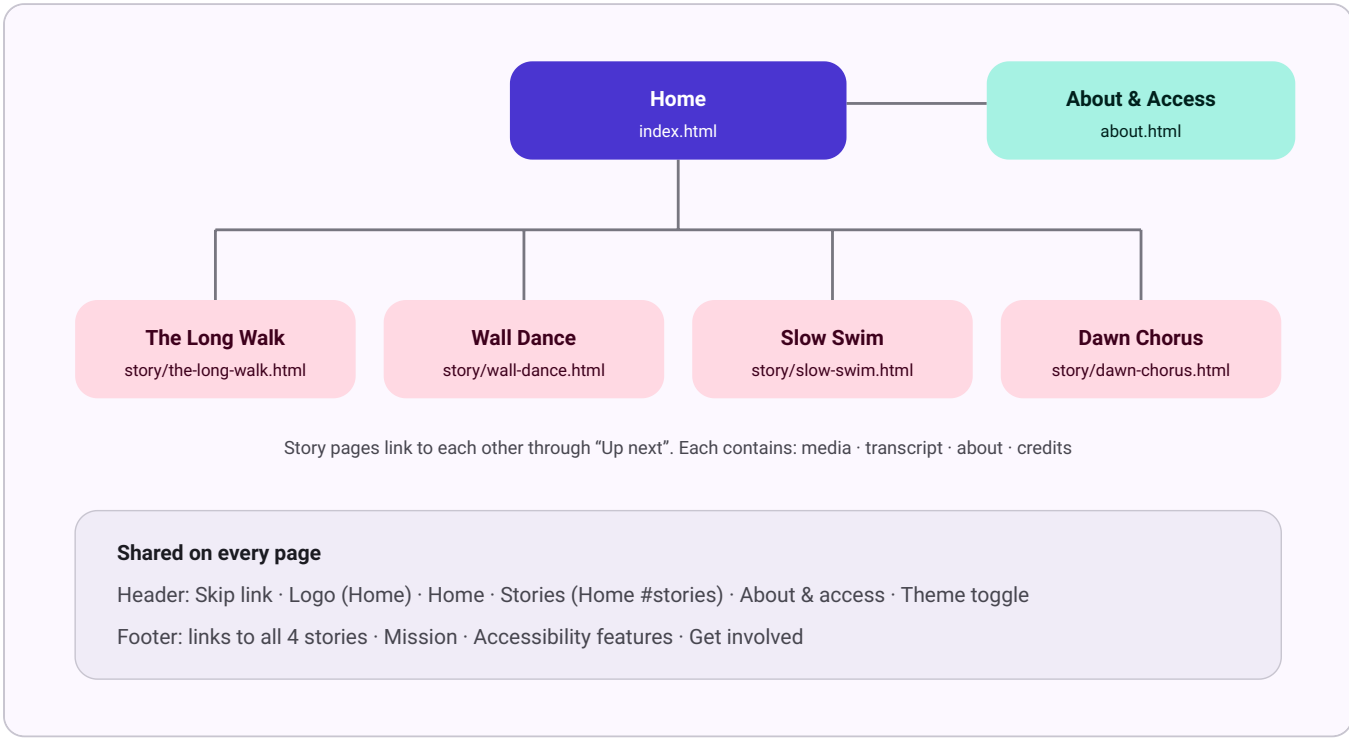
| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wall Dance | Video (native <video>), 0:11, silent | Cloudinary sample library | A person telling a story through movement rather than words. |
| Slow Swim | Video (native <video>), 0:15, silent | Cloudinary sample library | A short, calm clip that is a gentle first try of audio description. |
| Dawn Chorus | Audio (native <audio>), 0:45 | StoryCast original | An audio story with a captions track and an interactive transcript. |

## 4. Pattern review

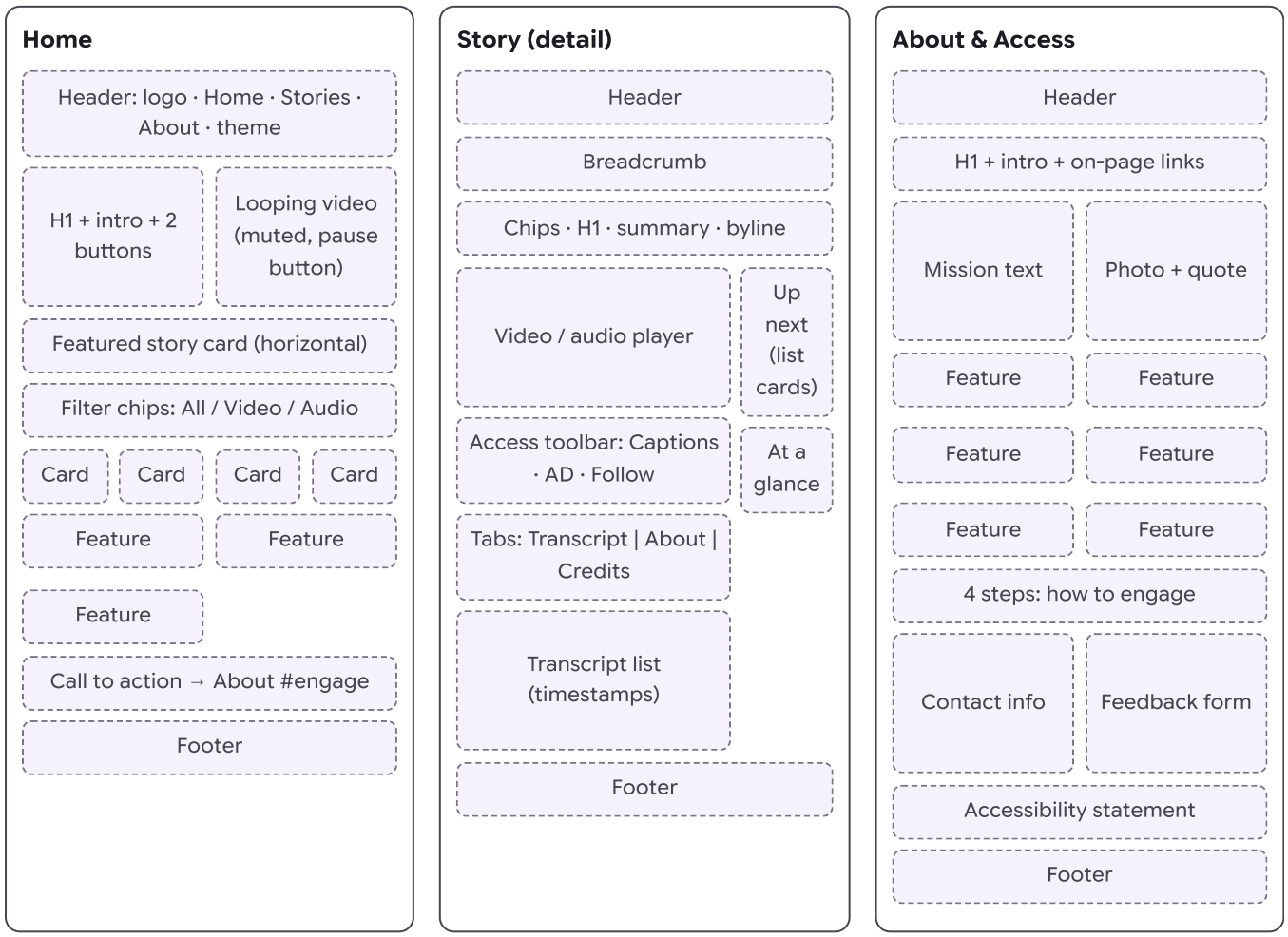
| Reference | What works | What StoryCast does differently |
|---|---|---|
| YouTube watch page | Familiar player, "Up next" list, transcript panel | Transcript is visible by default in a tab, not hidden in a menu |
| Story and podcast sites | Strong human stories, transcripts on some pages | Every story page has the same structure: media → transcript → about → credits |
| Podcast apps | Simple play controls, chapters | Timestamped transcript lines act as chapters and seek the media |

## 5. Information architecture

Three page types: **Home**, **Story (detail)** ×4, and **About & Access**. The global navigation has three items, each at most one click away from any page.



## 6. Wireframes (low fidelity)




Mobile: every layout collapses to one column, the navigation becomes a menu button, and "Up next" moves below the transcript.

**High-fidelity mockups (Figma):** https://www.figma.com/design/GPUgX9O6oZdRDJkFPEPqra

**Wireframes (Figma):** https://www.figma.com/design/GPUgX9O6oZdRDJkFPEPqra?node-id=19-2

## 7. Design system

- **Style:** Google Material 3: flat tonal surfaces, rounded shapes, pill navigation, state layers. No gradients.
- **Colour roles:** primary indigo `#4a35d0`, secondary teal `#006b5f` (audio), tertiary magenta `#ad1660` (video), with light and dark schemes. Every text pairing ≥ 4.5:1.
- **Type:** Google Sans Flex, Material type scale, fluid display sizes, body ≥ 16px.
- **Spacing:** 4px grid; 48px minimum touch targets.
- **Icons:** Material Symbols Rounded, always decorative and paired with text.

## 8. Accessibility approach & test plan

| Check | Method |
| --- | --- |
| Automated WCAG 2.1 A/AA rules | axe-core on every page, light + dark, 1440px + 390px |
| Colour contrast | Script checks every token pairing in `_colors.scss` |
| Keyboard | Tab through each page; tabs (arrow keys), menu (Esc), player shortcuts |
| Screen reader | NVDA + Firefox, VoiceOver + Safari (to do with real users) |
| Zoom / reflow | 320px width and 400% zoom without horizontal scroll |